

Task 5A

DIGITAL LITERACY

CASE STUDY

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Course: Digital Literacy

Course Code: CSE0001

The Crime

UPI payment fraud is a type of online financial fraud where scammers manipulate victims into transferring money or revealing sensitive information through deceptive tactics on platforms like Google Pay, PhonePe, or Paytm.

The following is a fictional case, taken as an example to shed light on cyber crimes.

How It Happened

Riya, a 20-year-old college student in, posted her old laptop for sale on OLX at ₹18,000. A buyer named "Arjun" contacted her, expressed immediate interest, and asked for her UPI ID to "send an advance payment". Arjun sent a UPI request for ₹18,000 (not a payment) but told Riya to "accept it to receive the money". Riya, unfamiliar with the difference between sending and receiving on UPI, entered her PIN to "accept". ₹18,000 was instantly debited from her account. Arjun's number was immediately switched off.

Who Is Usually Targeted

First-time sellers on platforms like OLX and Facebook Marketplace, college students, and anyone unfamiliar with how UPI requests work are the most common targets.

Consequences

Riya lost her money and had no immediate legal recourse as the transaction appeared voluntary. She filed a complaint on cybercrime.gov.in and called 1930, but fund recovery wasn't guaranteed.

This case highlights one critical fact, on UPI, receiving money never requires your PIN.